BBA · PRINCIPLES OF MARKETING

Marketing Management Orientations

Five philosophies that shape how organisations think, sell, and create value



An interactive session with real brand examples and a group activity

What Is a Marketing Orientation?

Marketing management orientations are the philosophies that guide how an organisation prioritises:

- Production efficiency
- Product quality & innovation
- Sales volume
- Customer satisfaction
- **Societal well-being**

These choices shape strategy, customer interaction, and ultimately, profitability.

5 ORIENTATIONS



1. Production



2. Product



3. Selling



4. Marketing



5. Societal Marketing

EFFICIENCY-DRIVEN

Production Concept

01

Assumes consumers prefer products that are widely available and inexpensive. Management concentrates on improving production and distribution efficiency, scaling up operations to drive costs down and reach mass markets.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Fast-fashion brands and low-cost electronics manufacturers relying on high-volume, low-cost assembly lines.



Focus:
Volume & Cost

QUALITY-DRIVEN

Product Concept

02

Holds that consumers favour products offering the highest quality, performance, and innovative features. Companies continuously refine their products, often assuming a “better mousetrap” will sell itself.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Apple and high-end watchmakers engineering excellence into every detail, ahead of direct consumer feedback.



Focus: Quality & Innovation

PUSH-DRIVEN

Selling Concept

03

Assumes consumers will not buy enough unless the firm undertakes large-scale selling and promotion. The focus is on aggressively pushing products, often prioritising the sale over the long-term relationship.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Insurance, encyclopedia, and timeshare sales, where persuasive selling is needed to close the deal.



Focus:
Persuasion & Push

CUSTOMER-CENTRIC

Marketing Concept

04

Shifts the focus from “finding the right customers for your product” to “finding the right products for your customers.” Success comes from understanding target-market needs and delivering satisfaction better than competitors.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Amazon's customer-obsessed model, tailoring recommendations and logistics using granular consumer data.



Focus:
Customer Needs

VALUE & RESPONSIBILITY

Societal Marketing Concept

05

Holds that strategy should deliver value to customers while preserving or enhancing both consumer and societal long-term well-being — balancing company profit, consumer wants, and public interest.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Patagonia and The Body Shop, anchoring their brands on sustainability, ethical sourcing, and environmental care.



Focus:
People, Planet, Profit

Five Orientations at a Glance

Orientation	Core Belief	Primary Focus	Example
Production	Consumers want low cost & availability	Efficiency & scale	*Fast fashion*
Product	Consumers want quality & features	Innovation	*Apple*
Selling	Consumers must be persuaded to buy	Aggressive promotion	*Insurance sales*
Marketing	Consumers' needs come first	Customer satisfaction	*Amazon*
Societal	Society's well-being matters too	Ethics & sustainability	*Patagonia*

CLASS ACTIVITY

“Name That Orientation!”

Work in groups of 4–5. Read each brand scenario and decide which of the five orientations it reflects — then defend your answer in one line.

1
A no-frills airline brags only about its rock-bottom fares and packed flight schedule.

2
A door-to-door vacuum salesperson uses high-pressure tactics to close every visit.

3
A skincare startup surveys customers monthly and redesigns products around their feedback.

4
A luxury pen maker obsesses over craftsmanship, ignoring price and customer surveys.

5
A coffee chain sources beans fairly and funds reforestation with every cup sold.

DEBRIEF TIP
Ask one group per scenario to justify their choice out loud — then reveal the intended answer together.

Key Takeaway

Every strong strategy starts

by choosing an orientation —

and living up to it.

Most successful modern organisations blend the Marketing Concept with Societal responsibility.

Thank you — questions & discussion welcome